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Git Best Practices

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Summary of Git Best Practices

SHARE

- Commit Often
- Write Clear Commit Messages
- Use Branches
- Pull Before You Push
- Review Changes Before Committing
- Keep Repositories Small
- Use .gitignore
- Tag Releases

Commit Often

Make small, frequent commits to capture your progress.

This makes it easier to track changes and find bugs.

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```
[user@localhost] $ git commit -m "Add user authentication logic"
```

Write Clear Commit Messages

Use descriptive messages that explain *why* a change was made, not just what changed.

Good commit messages help you and your team understand the history of the project.

- **Be specific:** Say what and why, not just "Update" or "Fix".
- **Use the imperative mood:** For example, "Add login validation" instead of "Added login validation".

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git commit -m "Fix bug in user login validation"
```

REMOVE ADS

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This way, you can work on new ideas without affecting the main codebase.

- **Why?** Branches let you test and develop independently, and make collaboration safer.
- **Name branches clearly:** For example, `feature/login-form` or `bugfix/user-auth`.

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git checkout -b feature/login-form
```

Pull Before You Push

Always `git pull` before pushing.

This updates your local branch with changes from others, helps you avoid conflicts, and ensures your push will succeed.

Why? If someone else has pushed changes since your last pull, your push may be rejected or cause conflicts.

Pulling first lets you fix any issues locally.

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git pull origin main
[user@localhost] $ git push origin main
```

Review Changes Before Committing

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Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git status
[user@localhost] $ git diff
```

Keep Repositories Small

Avoid adding large files or unnecessary dependencies.

This keeps your repository fast and easy to clone.

- **Tip:** For large files (like videos or datasets), use Git LFS (Large File Storage) instead of adding them directly to your repo.

Use .gitignore

Exclude files that shouldn't be tracked (like build artifacts, log files, or secrets) by adding them to a `.gitignore` file.

Note: `.gitignore` only prevents new files from being tracked.

Files already tracked by Git will remain in the repository until you remove them with `git rm --cached <file>`.

Example: .gitignore

```
[user@localhost] $ # .gitignore
node_modules/
```

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Tag Releases

Use tags to mark release points (like `v1.0`) so you can easily find and reference important versions.

This helps you keep track of your project's history and make it easier to roll back to previous versions if needed.

Example

```
[user@localhost] $ git tag v1.0
[user@localhost] $ git push origin v1.0
```

Note: Good Git habits make it easier for your team (and your future self) to understand and build on your work.

Exercise

Drag and drop the command to run before `git push` to avoid conflicts.

`git` ____

status add commit pull

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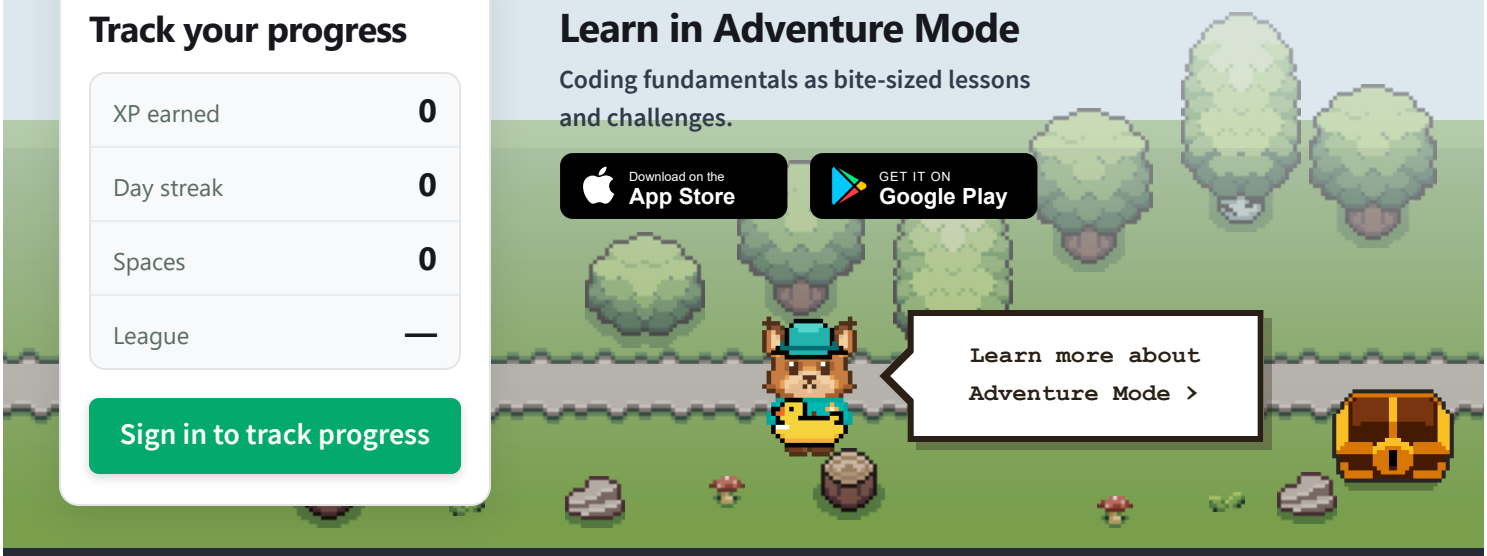
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